

Build a talk like software

manim-presentation-pipeline

2026-10-01

6:04 spoken at normal pace (135 wpm)

ACT 1: THE PROBLEM

B0 TITLE CARD (0:00-0:00)

1 (B0.1): "Build a talk like software" [before the talk starts]

(No narration: this is up while the room settles.)

B1 MOTION IS EXPENSIVE (0:00-0:30)

2 (B1.1): "An animated talk shows what slides can't." [click on "An animated talk"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

An animated talk shows what slides can't, and it's expensive to change.

When an idea is a process, motion carries it. A queue fills. A cache warms. The room watches it happen.

3 (B1.2): "Every change to an animation is code and a render." [click on "every frame of that is code"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

But every frame of that is code. A word you'd fix in a second on a slide becomes a scene to rewrite and render.

B2 NOTES ARRIVE LATE (0:30-0:55)

4 (B2.1): "The same note costs more the later it lands." [click on "Most notes arrive"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Most notes arrive when the deck is built, and that's where every change costs a render. On an outline, a note costs a line. In a finished deck, it costs a scene.

5 (B2.2): "Most notes land at the expensive end." [click on "the first time anyone sees the talk"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

And the deck is the first time anyone sees the talk. So that's where the notes land.

B3 CHECK WHERE IT'S CHEAP (0:55-1:20)

6 (B3.1): "Check each decision where it's cheapest to change." [click on "So check each decision"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

So check each decision where it's cheapest to change. Split the work into stages. Each one ends with something short the author checks, before anything moves on.

7 (B3.2): "Nine stages, from a brief to a release." [click on "Let's walk through them"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Let's walk through them, with a talk about a cache.

ACT 2: THE STAGES

B9 BRIEF (1:20-2:00)

8 (B9.1): "The brief fixes what the talk is for." [click on "The brief fixes"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The brief fixes what the talk is for, before anyone writes a line. Here's the brief for the cache talk. Who's in the room: the systems group. Ten minutes, at a normal pace. And the one sentence they should leave with. A cache that warms itself halves the slowest waits.

9 (B9.2): "The author checks the audience, the slot, the one sentence." [click on "The author checks three things"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author checks three things. Who's in the room. How long, and how fast. And the one sentence. Everything after this is measured against it.

B10 DIGEST (2:00-2:35)

10 (B10.1): "The digest lists what the talk could say, with sources." [click on "The digest lists"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The digest lists everything the talk could say, each with its source. Here, three claims, each pointing at the file it comes from. One of them is the result. The slowest waits halve once the cache is warm.

11 (B10.2): "The author sorts every item and answers every gap." [click on "The author marks each one"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author marks each one must,
could, or leave out. And answers
every gap the agent found.

B11 PEAK 1: OUTLINE, AND ONE SENTENCE (2:35-3:15)

12 (B11.1): "The outline is the story on one page." [click on "The outline is the story"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The outline is the story on one page. First, a few small options for each decision. The hook, the thread, the peaks. The author picks. Then one page. Every beat, its one line, its time.

13 (B11.2): "From here on, follow one sentence." [click on "From here on"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

From here on, let's follow one sentence. The result becomes beat three of the cache talk, with a minute and ten seconds.

14 (B11.3): "The author checks the picks and the page." [click on "The author checks the picks"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author checks the picks, and the story on one page. A wrong turn costs a line here.

B12 SCRIPT (3:15-3:55)

15 (B12.1): "The script is what the speaker says, written for the ear." [click on "The script is what the speaker says"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The script is what the speaker says, written for the ear. Short sentences, one idea each. Our sentence is now the line the speaker has to say, in bold, with the support around it.

16 (B12.2): "The author reads every act aloud." [click on "The author reads every act aloud"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author reads every act aloud.
 The time comes back against the
 slot. And a line they'd say
 differently, they say, and the
 script takes their words.

B13 VISUAL (3:55-4:40)

17 (B13.1): "The storyboard splits the script into clicks."
 [click on "The storyboard splits"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

**The storyboard splits the script
 into clicks.** Our sentence becomes
 one frame. A headline, the words
 that fire the click, and what's said
 while it's up. From now on the
 storyboard holds every word, and the
 script is printed from it.

18 (B13.2): "The greybox shows every slide as rough boxes."
 [click on "The greybox shows"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The greybox shows every slide as
 rough grey boxes, with its words
 underneath.

19 (B13.3): "The author checks the greybox, slide by slide."
 [click on "The author checks it slide by slide"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author checks it slide by slide.
 One claim per slide. Each click on
 the word it shows. Nothing is
 rendered yet.

B14 DESIGN (4:40-5:05)

20 (B14.1): "The design system fixes the look once." [click
 on "The design system fixes the look"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

**The design system fixes the look
 once, on one page.** Colours with
 their roles, the type, how each
 recurring object is drawn.

21 (B14.2): "The author checks the specimen." [click on "The
 author checks that one page"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author checks that one page, the specimen. Or starts from a house style they already have.

B15 BUILD (5:05-5:40)

22 (B15.1): "The build renders the deck, drafts first."
[click on "The build renders the deck"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The build renders the deck, act by act, as small drafts first. Every slide carries a plain number, and the draft carries the commit it was built from. Checks run on every click.

23 (B15.2): "The author checks stills, then clicks through."
[click on "The author looks at stills"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author looks at stills of every slide, then clicks through each act.

B6 PEAK 2: REHEARSAL, A LATE NOTE GOES HOME (5:40-6:35)

24 (B6.1): "Rehearsal: a late note goes back to the earliest stage it changes." [click on "In rehearsal"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

In rehearsal, a late note goes back to the earliest stage it changes, and everything after it is rebuilt. Say a reviewer writes, slide seven, say halves, not forty-eight percent.

25 (B6.2): "Slide 7 is beat 3, frame 2 in the draft the reviewer saw." [click on "Slide seven is just the number"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Slide seven is just the number on the screen. The agent looks up which frame that was, in the draft the reviewer saw. Beat three, frame two.

26 (B6.3): "The note is said back with its stage, and fixed there." [click on "Then it says the note back"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Then it says the note back, with its stage. A script note. The author confirms. The fix goes into the storyboard, not into the scene.

27 (B6.4): "Everything after it is rebuilt; only what changed is shown again." [click on "made again"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The script and the deck are made again, and only what changed comes back for a look. **The note lands where it belongs, so it costs a sentence again.**

B16 FINAL (6:35-7:00)

28 (B16.1): "The final stage releases the talk." [click on "The final stage releases"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The final stage releases the talk.
The full-quality deck, a static copy, the script, and the design system, in one folder. It's refused while a stage is unapproved or a note is open.

29 (B16.2): "The author clicks through once, end to end." [click on "The author clicks through it once"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The author clicks through it once, end to end.

ACT 3: USING IT

B7 USING IT (7:00-7:30)

30 (B7.1): "Clone it, write only in talk/, point any agent at AGENTS.md." [click on "To use it"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

To use it, clone the repository, write only in the talk folder, and point any agent at the agents file.
The instructions are plain text, so any coding agent can follow them.

31 (B7.2): "One command checks the machine; one builds the deck, offline." [click on "One command checks"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

One command checks your machine. One builds the deck, and it works offline.

B8 PEAK 3: THIS SLIDE WAS A GREY BOX (7:30-8:00)

32 (B8.1): "This slide started as a grey box." [click on "This talk was made this way"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE
**This talk was made this way. This
 slide started as a grey box.**

33 (B8.2): "Every stage was checked before the next." [click on "Nine stages"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE
 Nine stages, each checked before the
 next. That's how a late note goes
 back to costing a sentence. **Build a
 talk the way you build software. In
 stages, each checked cheaply by its
 author, from one source file.**

BACKUP

S1 WHAT THE BUILD CHECKS

34 (S1.1): "The build checks every click for text over text." [for questions]

(On request: the layout lint runs at every click of the check pass.)

35 (S1.2): "And every seam between slides for a jump." [for questions]

(On request: the last frame of each slide against the first frame of the next.)